



**Telling your employer**  
There's no requirement that dictates you tell your employer about your pregnancy. But you may decide to tell a boss or supervisor, as many women do, by the time you're showing.

**Baby equipment** Start thinking about the equipment you will need for your baby. You'll want to try out strollers, car seats, front-pack carriers, and slings. Think about whether your baby will sleep in a crib or bassinet.

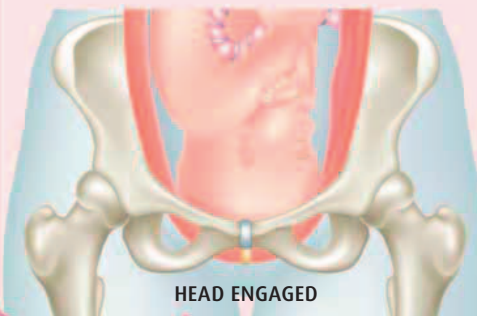
**Your birth plan** Now is a good time to decide where you would like to give birth, who you would like to be there, and the labor techniques you might consider.

**Whooping cough vaccine**  
This is offered to you between 28 and 38 weeks. It protects your baby from birth until her first vaccinations.

**Childbirth classes**  
Classes may start around now. They are popular, so enroll at least 12 weeks in advance. Your doctor will explain what is available.

## YOUR BABY'S POSITION

At this late stage, your baby's growth continues to be assessed as well as the efficiency of the placenta. By this point, your baby is nearly at full term and space is tight inside your uterus. Her head may begin to move into the pelvic cavity. Engagement occurs when the widest part of the baby's head has entered the pelvic inlet. This is one of the ways your body prepares itself for labor.



**Due date** It's normal for babies to be born between 37 and 42 weeks, so don't worry if yours hasn't arrived.

## Third trimester

21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32 33 34 35 36 37 38 39 40+

### YOUR MOVING BABY

For the last couple of weeks your baby's movements have become more obvious; you may be able to feel her hiccups and she will be growing used to the sound of your voice. Be aware of your baby's pattern of behavior and report unusual changes to your doctor.

**The nesting instinct** Try to rest as much as you can. If you feel the urge to clean and scrub, be careful not to overdo it.

**Prepare your hospital bag** Pack your hospital bag well in advance, in case you go into labor early. Add a copy of your birth plan. Make sure your birth partner knows where everything is.

**Preparing for labor** Practice exercises that might ease labor. Spend time on all fours or sitting on an exercise ball; start relaxation and breathing techniques; try massaging your perineum to make the area more supple.

### COMMON SIDE EFFECTS OF PREGNANCY

Many women feel full of energy and positive in the second trimester. You may begin to experience common side effects, including swollen hands and feet, bleeding gums, hemorrhoids, cramps, and skin changes. Some women get a dark line called a linea nigra on their abdomen that fades after birth.



KICKING  
INSIDE THE  
UTERUS

### ARE YOU READY?

Watch out for early labor signs such as a "bloody show," water breaking, and contractions beginning. If you go over 41 to 42 weeks you'll be overdue. This is very common and you can speak to your doctor about the next course of action.

